Q+A

Everyone Loves a Good Villain

Singer-actor **Ila Arun**'s turn in Hotstar's *Aarya 3: Antim Vaar* as a menacing villain shows her versatility

Q. How did it feel to play such a negative character?

It is against my nature to be vindictive but then that is the true challenge for an actor—to portray what is not natural to you with conviction. I believe that every character has many shades and one has to take into account all the factors that have contributed to the creation of that personality. To play a role different from your own personality is an artistic achievement and I am glad I could accomplish it.

Q. Singer or actor, which do you lean more towards?

Thanks to my singing for films, I am popular as a singer, but I have actually been a theatre person for over four decades. My heart is in theatre. I have written five adaptations of Henrik Ibsen's plays and co-directed two along with K.K. Raina as well as acted in them.

Q. What is your dream role?

I want to do roles that will have me enter a world that I have not experienced before. Playing the role of a person with a weakness and the helplessness of having to function in a society that does not understand that weakness is a big challenge for any actor. To genuinely portray how that person feels or functions would be a big accomplishment.

Q. What was it like, working with Sushmita Sen?

I have worked with Sushmita earlier, when I played her mother in *Chingaari*. I have always found her to be a very strong and, at the same time, a very soft person. It is remarkable to see how she came back to work after her heart attack and did all the action scenes with so much dedication.

—with Shashi Sunny

Photograph by MILIND SHELTE